

Strategy Brief #2

Regional Population Exposure – Eastern Gulf of Guinea



Quantifying how rapid demographic growth in low-lying coastal zones, amplified by informal settlements and data scarcity, is dramatically increasing the number of people exposed to flooding, displacement, and humanitarian risk by 2050.

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<https://chounnagerginoy.github.io/>

Introduction

The eastern Gulf of Guinea is experiencing rapid demographic growth, particularly in coastal cities, combined with increasing environmental pressures such as sea-level rise and land subsidence.

Key Challenge

A growing share of the population is settling in low-lying coastal zones, increasing exposure to flooding, infrastructure disruption, and long-term displacement risks.

Strategic Insights

- Coastal population growth is **outpacing urban planning capacity.**
- Exposure is amplified by **informal settlements in high-risk areas.**
- Data scarcity limits **accurate risk quantification and planning.**
- Future projections indicate a **significant increase in exposed populations by 2050.**

Strategic Implications

- Rising exposure will place **pressure on public services and infrastructure.**
- Increased risk of **humanitarian crises and economic disruption.**
- Governments face **escalating adaptation costs.**

Recommendations

- Integrate **population exposure mapping** into **planning frameworks**.
- Strengthen **urban development control** in **high-risk zones**.
- Invest in **data systems and monitoring tools**.
- Promote **risk-informed spatial planning policies**.



Value Proposition

Improved population risk assessment enables better-targeted investments and reduced long-term vulnerability.